

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

A model for resistance?

Activists share blueprint as Border Patrol hits the road

By **Laura Turbay and Jake Sheridan**
Chicago Tribune

It's a story repeating itself: Border Patrol agents flooding immigrant neighborhoods, showing dramatic force, storming Home Depot parking lots and preying on people at courthouses.

Those arrests erupted in Chicago. Then they were 750 miles away in Charlotte, North Carolina. And they will keep roving across the country.

But no matter where they go, Chicago-ans will try to stop them.

As President Donald Trump's ramped-up Border Patrol action hits city after city, Chicago's immigration-focused community organizers are following. They aim to pass on what they learned to foster pushback in Operation Midway Blitz.

The resistance effort, which was backed by top elected officials in Illinois, provides a blueprint for immigration activists nationwide: lawsuits, whistles, cellphone cameras and more.

Chicago's immigration advocacy groups,

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CHICAGO-BORN SENATOR ASSAILS FEDERAL RAIDS:

U.S. Sen. Ruben Gallego walked down 26th Street in Little Village on Friday morning while moments from his past came back to life. But now the community feels threatened, constantly, and the Arizona lawmaker said he could sense residents' stress during his visit. **Chicagoland, Page 4**

■ Gun charges have been unsealed against a man who allegedly aimed a gun near where federal immigration agents said that someone shot at them. **Chicagoland, Page 4**

CHICAGO POLICE DEPARTMENT

Pilot to file gun charges grows

Controversial program to expand cops' powers goes citywide following review

By **Madeline Buckley**
Chicago Tribune

The Cook County state's attorney's office is expanding citywide a program that allows Chicago police officers to directly file charges in some low-level felony gun cases, following a review of pilots in two police districts.

The program, which means prosecutors in the office's Felony Review Unit will not first assess charges in some cases, has been controversial among some advocacy groups and community members, who objected to the pilot programs starting out in majority-Black neighborhoods and argued that an initial review was an important oversight measure.

But officials with the state's attorney's office said prosecutors still review the charges early in the case, adding that the process change has eased bottlenecks and freed up prosecutors and police officers for higher priority, victim-centric work.

"There is nothing more painful and tedious for victims or witnesses who have experienced something significantly difficult in life than having to wait in a police station for hours and hours and hours," said Yvette Loizon, chief of policy at the state's attorney's office. "Oftentime when that happens, they throw up their hands and leave."

Charges that are eligible for the program are three common low-level gun felonies that do not involve a victim or a discharge of the weapon.

The Felony Review Unit is staffed at all hours by assistant state's attorneys who work with police to evaluate whether charges are appropriate, often — for more serious cases — traveling to the police districts to interview witnesses

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INSIDE

Navy ships are straying from alleged drug routes

The U.S. Navy has routinely been positioning warships near Venezuela's coast in locations far from the Caribbean's main drug-smuggling routes, suggesting that the buildup is focused more on a pressure campaign against Venezuela than on the counternarcotics operation the Trump administration says it's waging. **Nation & World**

■ At Drury Lane, the nuns boogie, but "Sister Act" holds few surprises. **A+E**



TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Merry and bright

Fireworks erupt over Chicago's 112th official Christmas tree at the lighting ceremony Friday in Millennium Park. The 68-foot Norway spruce was felled from a Glenview family's front yard. The spruce, planted as a 1-foot sapling sometime in the 1980s, already towered over the Mason family's one-story home when they moved to the North Shore suburb 10 years ago. Jim Williams, who has handled transportation for the city's official tree for 16 years, says the Masons' tree is the largest Chicago has ever had.

Zelenskyy says Ukraine faces stark choice

US-backed plan bans entry to NATO, shrinks nation, army

By **Illia Novikov and Barry Hatton**
Associated Press

KYIV, Ukraine — Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy told his country in an address Friday that it could face a pivotal choice between standing up for its sover-

eign rights and preserving the American support it needs, as leaders discuss a U.S. peace proposal seen as favoring Russia.

Russian President Vladimir Putin, meanwhile, cautiously welcomed the U.S. plan to end Moscow's nearly four-year war in Ukraine, which contains many of the Kremlin's long-standing demands while offering limited security guarantees to Ukraine. Putin said it "could form the basis of a final peace settlement," while accusing Ukraine of opposing the plan and being

unrealistic.

The plan foresees Ukraine handing over territory to Russia — something Kyiv has repeatedly ruled out — while reducing the size of its army and blocking its coveted path to NATO membership.

Zelenskyy, in his address hours earlier, did not reject the plan outright, but he insisted on fair treatment while pledging to "work calmly" with Washington and

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Poll: Most Chicagoans want Bears to stay, but without tax-funded stadium

By **Robert McCoppin**
Chicago Tribune

Most Chicagoans want the Bears to stay in their city — but don't want to spend public money to keep them, a new survey has found.

More than two-thirds of those surveyed, 68%, said it was important to keep the team in Chicago, but an almost equal number, 65%, said the local government should spend no money to keep the team in the city.

Another 28% supported a moderate level of public funding. Only 7% said the city should spend significant amounts on the effort.

"It's a bit of a challenge for public officials,

most notably (Mayor) Brandon Johnson, because people are going to be upset if the Bears leave, but they're going to remove the most important tool to keep them here," said professor Christopher Berry, faculty director of the Mansueto Institute for Urban Innovation, which commissioned the poll. "It might be a lose-lose situation for the mayor."

For the team, Berry said, "It's a bit of a reality check in terms of what they're asking for."

After previously getting turned down by state officials for taxpayer funding to help replace Soldier Field on the city's lakefront, team officials have turned their focus to

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Fans cheer during the first half of the Bears' 2017 season opener against the Atlanta Falcons at Soldier Field in Chicago. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High **52** Low **37**

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 8

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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